

TRUSTMRR STARTUP ECOSYSTEM

INTELLIGENCE REPORT

Revenue Patterns, Market Dynamics &
Strategic Opportunities For Startups

1,000

Startups Analyzed

\$161.7M

Combined Est. ARR

26.2%

Listed for Acquisition

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Extreme Revenue Concentration

The top 10 startups (1%) generate 48% of all MRR. The top 50 capture 71%. Most startups operate below survival-level revenue.

AI Category: Biggest Sector, Middling Returns

AI is the largest category (197 startups, 20%), yet median MRR is only \$446 — B2B AI earns 5× more than B2C AI peers.

59% of Startups Earn Under \$1K/Month

Nearly 3 in 5 startups have not crossed the \$1K MRR threshold. The funnel from idea to viable business remains brutally narrow.

US Captures 56% of All MRR at 26% of Startups

American startups punch far above their weight. US founders earn 7× the median MRR of non-US peers — a structural advantage.

THE DATASET AT A GLANCE

1,000

Startups

across 50+ countries

\$13.5M

Total Monthly MRR

est. \$161.7M ARR

26

Categories

AI is largest at 20%

262

Listed for Acquisition

median ask \$35K

9

Payment Processors

Stripe powers 64%

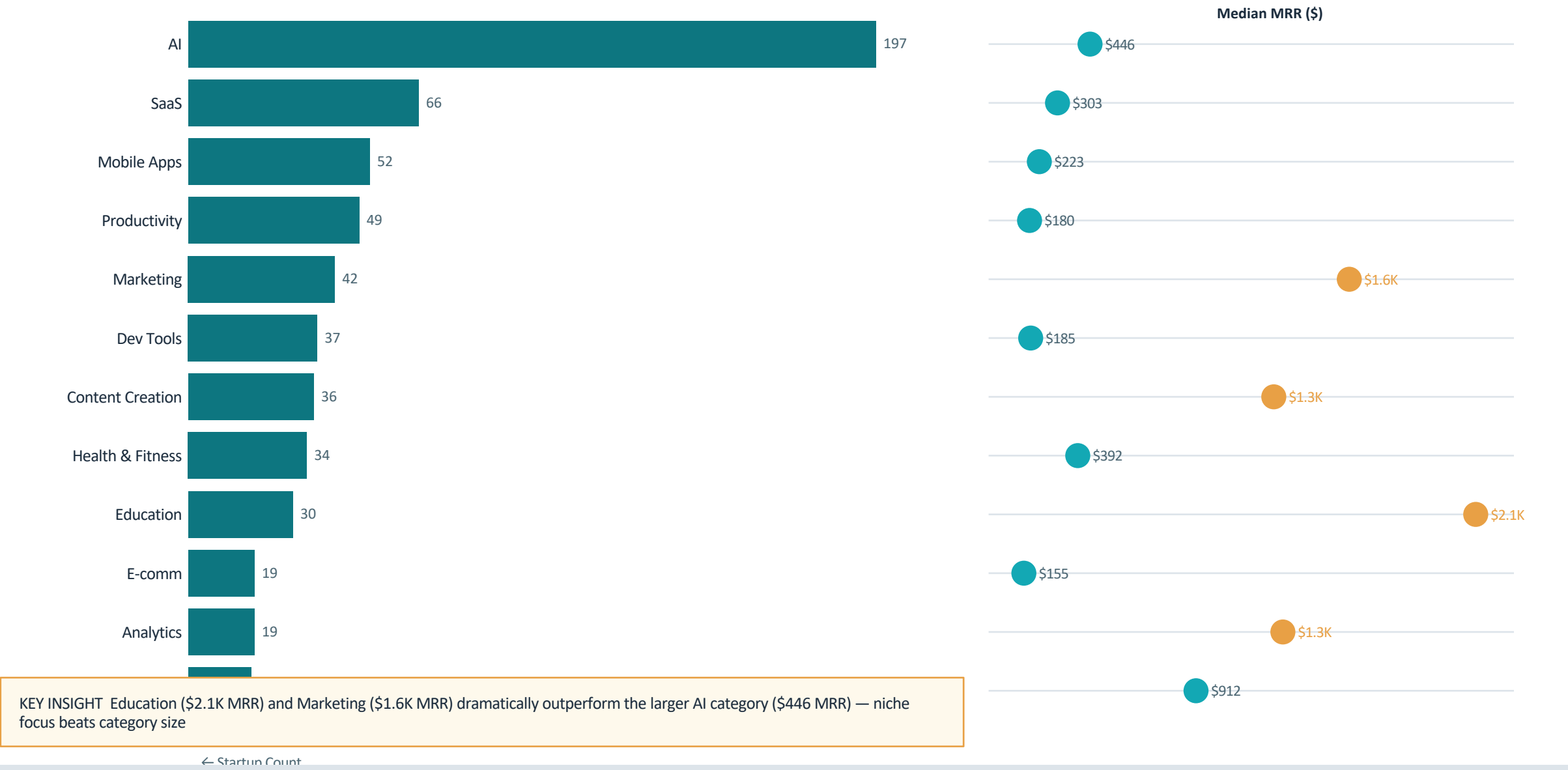
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Data Fields

per startup verified

CATEGORY LANDSCAPE: AI DOMINATES IN VOLUME, NOT IN REVENUE

Category share by startup count vs. median MRR reveals a striking mismatch - size does not equal performance



B2B FOUNDERS EARN 5.7× MORE THAN B2C COUNTERPARTS

Despite B2C having 57% more startups, B2B commands a commanding median revenue advantage at every tier

B2B

\$1,036

Median MRR

Startups in Dataset	255
Avg Active Subscriptions	16
Implied ARPU	\$49/mo
% with Positive 30d Growth	43%
Most Common Category	AI / SaaS

VS

B2C

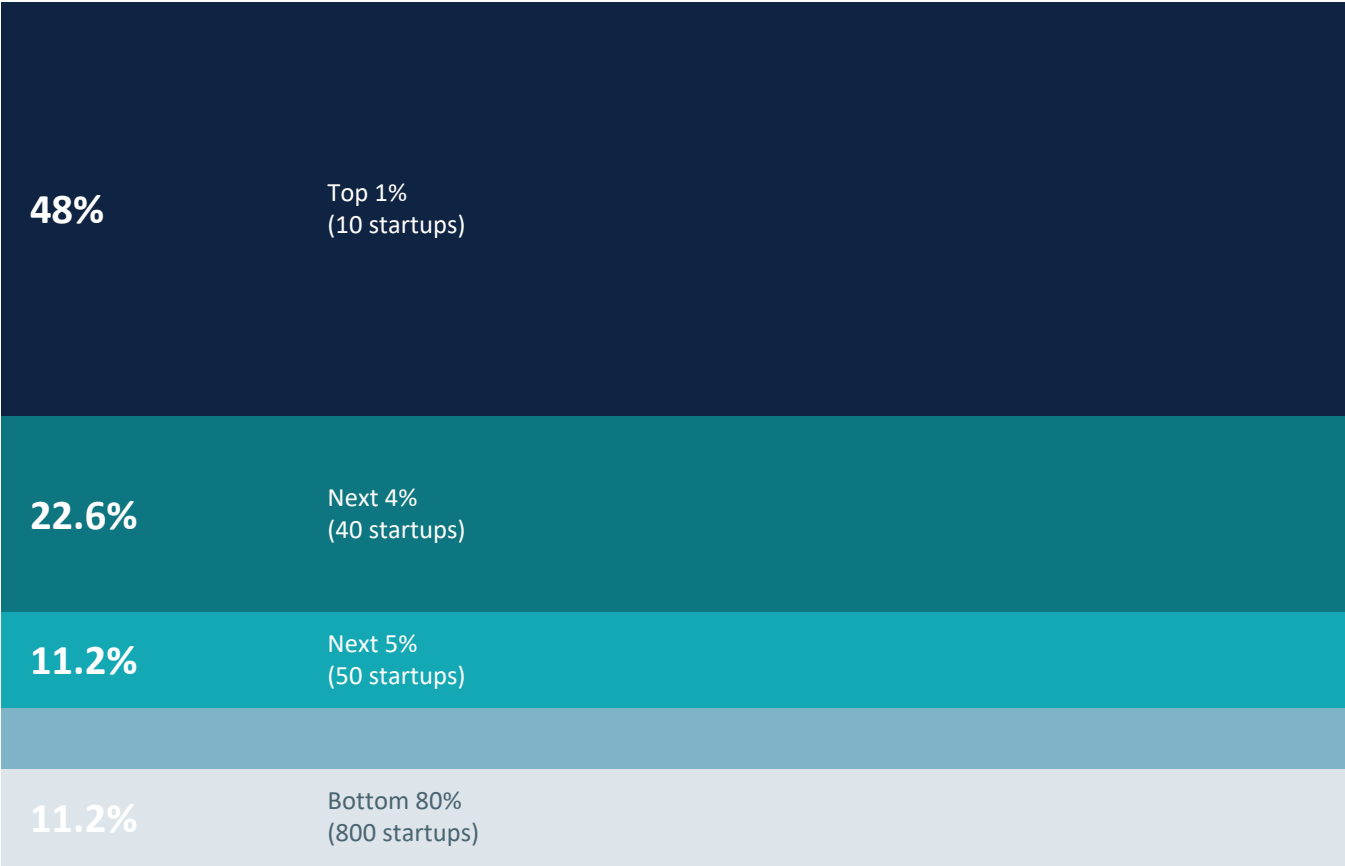
\$181

Median MRR

Startups in Dataset	401
Avg Active Subscriptions	19
Implied ARPU	\$9/mo
% with Positive 30d Growth	37%
Most Common Category	AI / Mobile Apps

THE 1% PROBLEM: EXTREME REVENUE CONCENTRATION IN THE STARTUP ECONOMY

Ten startups generate nearly half of all MRR — a Pareto curve steeper than most traditional industries



\$282

Median MRR
50th percentile startup

\$3,384

Median ARR
Annual revenue for mid-tier startup

Top 10

Startups Hold 48%
of all MRR in the dataset

197

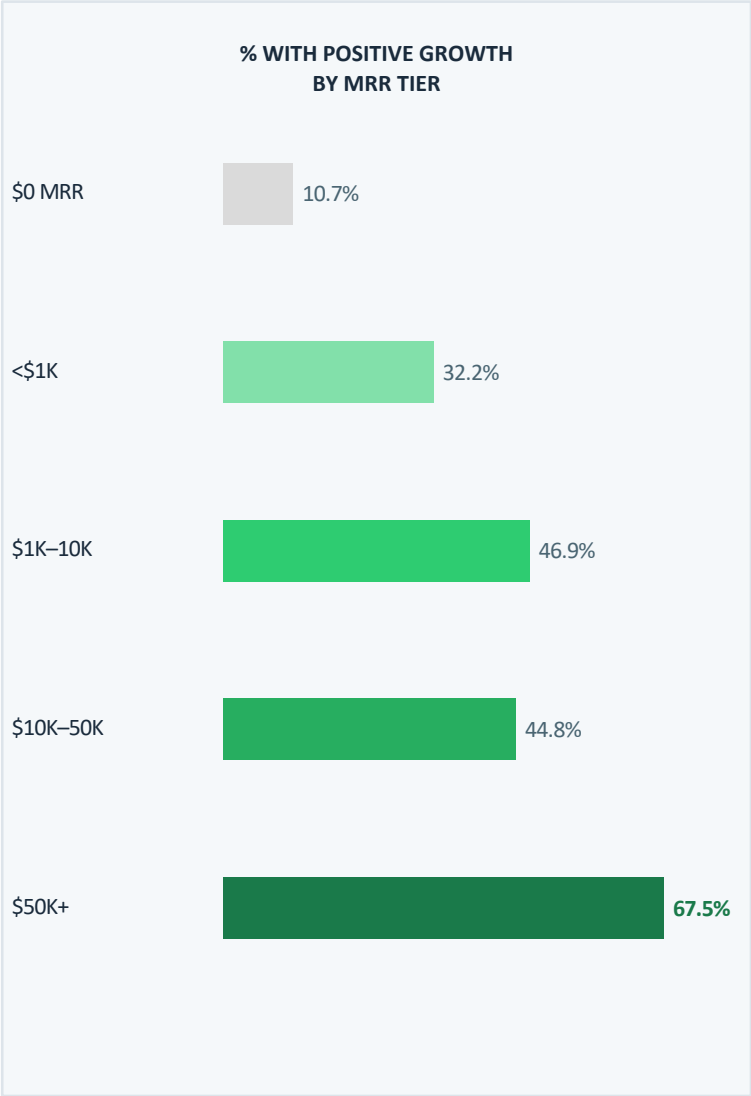
\$0 MRR Startups
19.7% have not yet monetized

GROWTH IS POLARIZED: 35% HYPER-GROWING, 34% IN DECLINE

Larger startups grow faster - the rich get richer dynamic is structurally reinforced by network effects and distribution



THE RICH GET RICHER Startups earning \$50K+ MRR are 6× more likely to be growing positively than those at \$0 MRR. Scale begets scale — early momentum is self-reinforcing.



GEOGRAPHY SHAPES DESTINY: US EARNS 7× MORE THAN THE GLOBAL MEDIAN

US startups represent 26% of the dataset but command 56% of total MRR — a structural advantage rooted in market size and ecosystem

Country	Startups	Median MRR	MRR Share	% Growing	Signal
 United States	258	\$1.3K	55.7%	43%	Dominant
 Singapore	9	\$2.1K	2.1%	44%	Punches above weight
 UAE	8	\$1.6K	1.3%	38%	Premium pricing
 Canada	29	\$919	5.2%	21%	Strong ecosystem
 Brazil	20	\$666	1.8%	45%	Emerging fast
 France	79	\$435	5.9%	44%	Second largest
 Australia	17	\$326	1.2%	59%	High growth rate
 Germany	24	\$230	1.5%	13%	Declining momentum
 United Kingdom	50	\$153	3.6%	28%	Underperforming
 India	59	\$6	1.8%	37%	Nascent market

India Paradox

59 startups (6th globally) yet median MRR of just \$6/mo — suggests a volume-over-value strategy misaligned with global pricing

Singapore Surprise

Only 9 startups, yet highest median MRR at \$2,126 — reflecting premium B2B focus and professional services positioning

Australia Leads Growth

Highest % with positive growth (58.8%) despite small size — possibly benefiting from underserved local markets

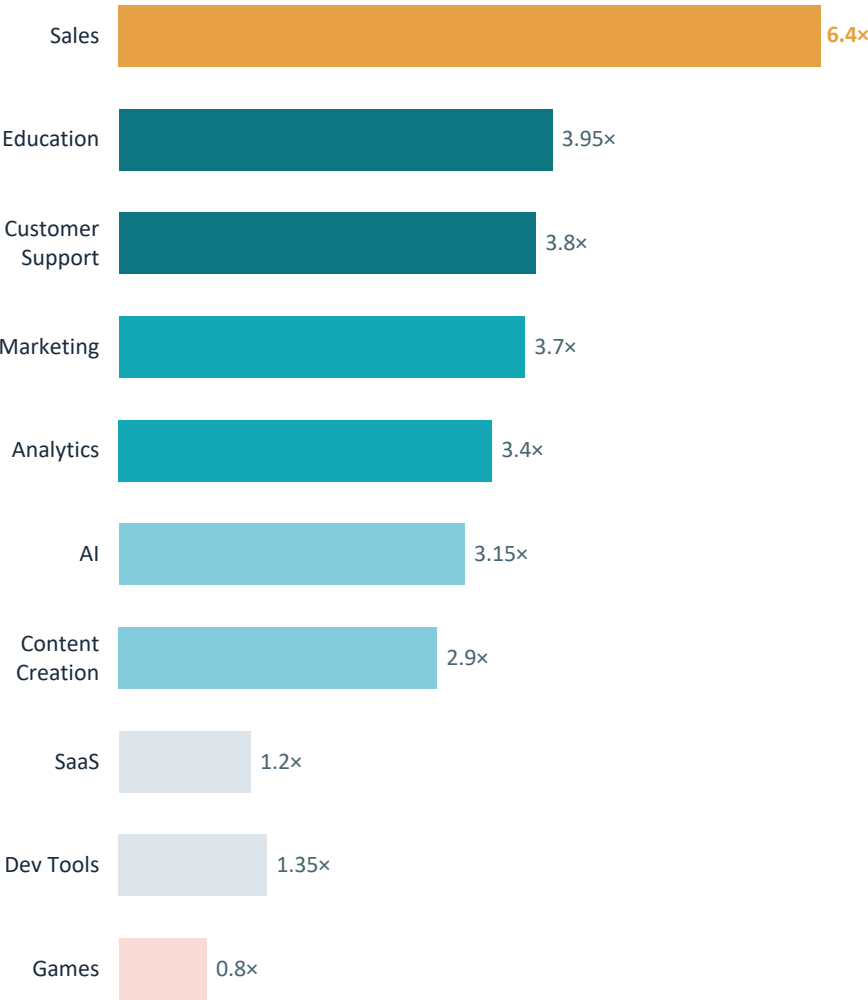
THE MICRO-ACQUISITION MARKET: 262 STARTUPS LISTED, MEDIAN ASK \$35K

A large and accessible M&A layer exists below the radar of traditional PE - with median revenue multiples of 2.3× MRR

ACQUISITION SNAPSHOT

Startups for Sale	26226.2% of all 1,000
Median Asking Price	\$35KAccessible to solo buyers
Mean Asking Price	\$332KSkewed by top outliers
Median Revenue Multiple	2.3×MRR basis
Highest Asking Price	\$10MStan — \$3.6M MRR
Lowest Asking Price	\$2,500Early-stage micro listings

MEDIAN REVENUE MULTIPLE BY CATEGORY



SURPRISING FINDINGS

Mobile Apps Exit Most

55.8% of Mobile App startups are for sale — highest of any category. Many app founders are burning out or cashing out early.

Low MRR, High Multiple

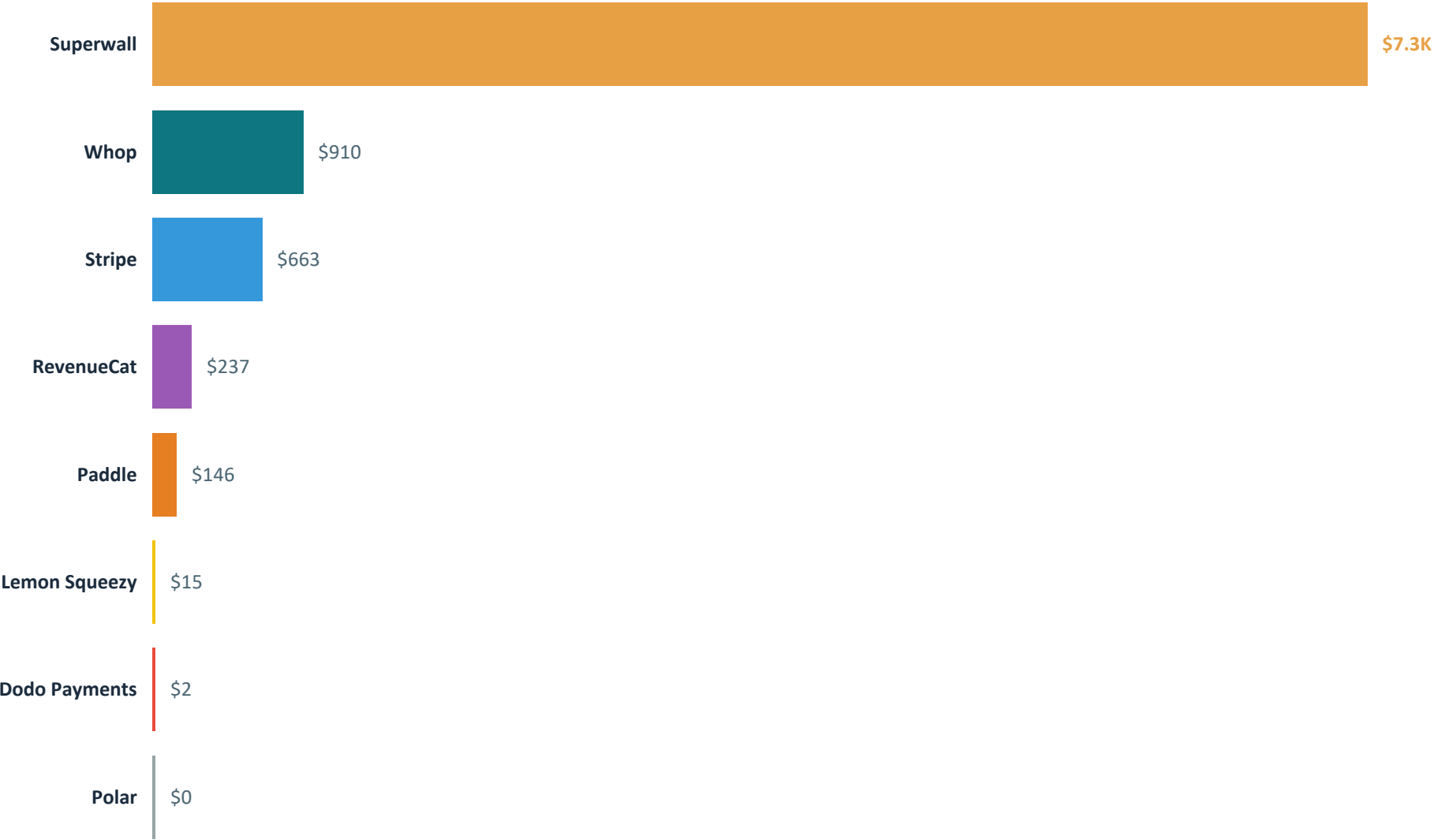
Sub-\$1K MRR startups average 3.4× multiple — often buyers are paying for audience or tech, not cash flow.

AI: Most Listed

54 AI startups are for sale (highest absolute count) — signaling category saturation and founder fatigue in competitive niches.

HIDDEN SIGNAL: PAYMENT PROCESSOR CHOICE PREDICTS REVENUE

Superwall-powered startups earn 11× more than Polar users - the infrastructure stack correlates with business model maturity



WHY IT MATTERS Payment processor choice is a proxy for business model sophistication. Superwall signals a mature mobile monetization strategy; Polar signals very early-stage open source. Acquirers and investors can use this as a first-pass filter.

COUNTERINTUITIVE FINDINGS THAT CHALLENGE CONVENTIONAL WISDOM

Four observations that would surprise most startup investors - each with significant strategic implications

01 Stealth Startups Earn 40× More

ASSUMPTION:

Transparency builds trust and attracts customers

REALITY:

The 131 "stealth" companies in this dataset earn a median MRR of \$7,337 vs \$184 for named companies - 40× higher. High-revenue startups guard their competitive information.

02 X Followers Don't Drive Revenue

ASSUMPTION:

Social media following converts to customers

REALITY:

Correlation between X followers and MRR is just 0.35 - weak. Some startups with 365K followers earn \$0 MRR. Domain authority ($r=0.42$) and active subscriptions ($r=0.70$) are far stronger revenue predictors.

03 AI B2B Earns 5× AI B2C — Same Category

ASSUMPTION:

AI products earn category-wide premiums

REALITY:

Within the AI category, B2B founders earn a median \$1,357 MRR vs \$278 for B2C - a 5× gap. The AI label is not the value driver; the customer segment is.

04 Low MRR Startups Command Higher Multiples

ASSUMPTION:

Higher revenue → higher acquisition multiple

REALITY:

Sub-\$1K MRR startups sell at a median 3.4× multiple vs 1.75× for \$50K+ startups. Buyers pay premiums for growth potential and early-stage assets - not established cash flows.

STRATEGIC IMPLICATIONS FOR THREE DISTINCT AUDIENCES

The same dataset contains different decision signals depending on your role - investor, founder, or acquirer

INVESTORS & LPs

- Revenue concentration is extreme - top 1% holds 48% of MRR. Build portfolios that account for power-law outcomes, not normal distributions.
- B2B AI has 5× the revenue upside of B2C AI - filter deal flow accordingly. The category label is less important than the buyer type.
- Growth-at-scale is self-reinforcing - companies above \$50K MRR grow at 67.5% positive rate vs 10.7% near zero. Prioritize momentum over potential.
- US geographic premium is real and durable - weight toward US-domiciled or US-market-targeted products for risk-adjusted returns.

FOUNDERS & BUILDERS

- B2B positioning unlocks 5.7× higher median MRR than B2C for the same product category - redesign your ICP if you're B2C-first.
- Domain authority ($r=0.42$) matters more than social followers ($r=0.35$) for revenue. Invest in SEO, not vanity metrics.
- \$1K MRR is the pivotal threshold: probability of positive growth jumps from 32% to 47% once crossed. Obsess over this milestone.
- Education, Marketing, and Customer Support categories dramatically outperform AI on a per-startup median basis - niche often beats hype.

ACQUIRERS & AGGREGATORS

- 262 startups are actively for sale with a median ask of \$35K - an underserved deal market below the radar of institutional capital.
- Superwall users signal mobile monetization sophistication - use payment stack as a screening filter for operational quality.
- Small (<\$1K MRR) assets trade at 3.4× multiple vs 1.75× for larger ones - roll-up economics favor buying early-stage and growing in portfolio.
- Mobile Apps category is most eager to exit (56% listed) - potential for themed vertical roll-ups in health, productivity, or entertainment.

RECOMMENDATIONS: PRIORITIZED BY EVIDENCE STRENGTH AND IMPACT

Five data-driven recommendations, each with supporting evidence and expected impact - ordered by implementation priority

IMMEDIATE	01	Reposition AI Products Toward B2B Buyers EVIDENCE AI B2B median MRR (\$1,357) is 5× AI B2C (\$278). 197 AI startups compete for the same B2C attention with \$446 median revenue.	IMPACT 5× MRR uplift potential for B2C-positioned AI products that successfully pivot to B2B pricing and ICP
IMMEDIATE	02	Deploy Capital Into Micro-Acquisition Roll-Ups EVIDENCE 262 startups for sale, median ask \$35K, median 2.3× multiple. Mobile Apps category: 56% listed - highest exit intent.	IMPACT Portfolio of 10 micro-acquisitions at median price = \$350K total deployed vs. one seed deal at same cost
90 DAYS	03	Use Payment Stack as First-Pass Investment Screen EVIDENCE Superwall users earn 11× more than Polar; RevenueCat = B2C mobile (lower ARPU); Stripe = broadest quality mix.	IMPACT Reduces time-to-qualified-deal by screening for monetization sophistication before revenue review
90 DAYS	04	Prioritize Domain Authority Over Social Followers EVIDENCE Domain rating correlates 0.42 with MRR; X followers correlate only 0.35. SEO compounds; social following doesn't.	IMPACT Founders redirecting 20% of content marketing budget to SEO/backlinks should see 2–3× better revenue correlation
STRATEGIC	05	Focus Geo-Expansion on US Markets First EVIDENCE US median MRR is 7× non-US. US startups generate 56% of all MRR from 26% of startups. Market size and English-language distribution matter.	IMPACT Non-US founders targeting US pricing and distribution could double addressable revenue without changing product

CONCLUSION

The micro-startup economy is a power law world - and the levers that separate winners from the long tail are knowable.

1 The top 1% of startups hold 48% of all MRR. This is a winner-takes-most ecosystem, not a democratic one.

2 B2B beats B2C by 5.7× at the median. The customer segment matters more than the product category.

3 59% of startups haven't crossed \$1K MRR. The hardest step is first - but growth compresses sharply once scale begins.

4 26% of startups are for sale, with accessible price points below \$35K median. Micro-M&A is a real and underserved market.

5 US, B2B, Education, and Marketing positioning are the highest-signal factors for durable revenue - more than AI labeling.